

For this lab, I did not have to install the local development environment and FileZilla because I had those already from my WebTech class.

The first thing I found confusing is these two commands. I had to go and learn about them.

`mkdir -p ~/Desktop/tasks-app`: Creating the project's folder called tasks-app, especially the -p, which is still confusing for me. I understood that it is used to create the parent folder if it does not already exist. This made me start asking questions like, why do we need the parent folder and what does it do? I learned that the parent folder is basically the folder that contains another folder or files. In this case, tasks-app is the folder where I will keep the files for my project.

`cd ~/Desktop/tasks-app`: Entering inside the project folder and telling the terminal that whatever is happening next should go to this folder, so files can be created inside that folder.

After that, I had to gain access to the school server. I used SSH through PowerShell with the username, IP address, and port that were provided to us. I found this part a little confusing because I was not just opening a folder on my own computer anymore. I was connecting to another computer through the server.

When I first logged in, I also had to change my password. I think institutions make users change their password when they first log in because the first password is usually a temporary password that may have been given to the student or administrator. If everyone keeps the temporary password, there is a higher chance that someone else could know it and use the account. Changing it makes the account more personal and reduces the risk of unauthorized access.

Error and confusion I encountered

One of the challenges I faced was the Permission denied error when I was trying to connect to the server using SSH. I entered my password, but it did not allow me to log in. I had to go back and check the username, IP address, port, and password I was using.

Another thing that confused me was when the lab asked me for a phpMyAdmin password or a server password. At first, I was not completely sure which password I was supposed to use because I was working with both my local XAMPP environment and the school server. I ended up trying the passwords I had, and this made me realize that they are not necessarily the same password.

The server password is used to authenticate me when I connect to the school server through SSH, while the phpMyAdmin/MySQL password is related to accessing the database. Since I was working in two different environments, I had to pay more attention to where the password was being requested and what I was trying to access.

This experience taught me that an error or password problem is not always because the password itself is wrong. Sometimes the problem is that I am using the right password in the wrong place. It also helped me understand that different parts of a web application can have different authentication systems.

I also learned something about how errors are shown. As a developer, I can sometimes see more detailed information about what went wrong through the terminal or server logs. But a normal user visiting a website should not necessarily see all these details. For example, showing database passwords, file locations, or other technical information in an error message could

create a security problem. So developers need detailed errors when developing and fixing problems, but users should normally get a simpler error message.

Developing locally vs. using a live server

Working with XAMPP locally felt easier because everything was on my own computer. I could put my project inside htdocs, start Apache and MySQL, make changes, and test them. If something went wrong, I could change the files directly on my computer.

The live server was different because I had to think about things that I did not have to worry about as much when working locally. For example, I had to use SSH to access the server, deal with file permissions, make sure my files were in the correct `public_html` folder, and make sure the database connection was correct.

I also realized that the database settings might not be the same locally and on the live server. Something that works with XAMPP on my computer does not automatically mean that it will work on the school server.

Security is also more important when the project is on a live server. When I am working locally, other people normally cannot access my project directly. But once I put it on a server, other people can potentially access the website. This means I must be more careful with passwords, database information, file permissions, and the type of errors that my website shows.